Executive Summary - Embassy Outreach Review

Status as at 05 Oct 2026 | 91 raw records cleaned to 84 unique embassies across 6 regions | Illustrative sample database (see note at foot of page)

84	74	19	59	30	13
Embassies	Contacted (88%)	Fully engaged (23%)	Live pipeline	Overdue follow-ups	Stale 90+ days

1. Key observations

- **Reach is strong, depth is not.** 74 of 84 embassies (88%) have been contacted, but only 19 (23%) are fully engaged. Another 40 sit in early or active stages (initial contact, discussion, meeting scheduled), so the conversion of conversations into engagement is the main opportunity.
- **Follow-up discipline is the biggest risk.** 30 of 59 live embassies (51%) have a follow-up date that has already passed, and 13 (22%) have had no contact for 90+ days. Seven live embassies have no next-step date at all.
- **Regional engagement is uneven.** Sub-Saharan Africa leads (36% engaged) and Middle East & North Africa follows (29%); South & Central Asia (13%) and Europe (15%) lag. Europe is the largest region (20 embassies) and has four not yet approached. Asia-Pacific has 7 overdue follow-ups against only 8 live embassies.
- **Workload is uneven.** Priya Nair has 8 of 11 live embassies overdue; Sameer Khan has the longest average gap since last contact (about 117 days). Rahul Verma has 1 overdue of 9 live embassies, which shows good practice that can be shared.
- **Momentum is recent and fragile.** 26 embassies were last contacted in September 2026, compared with 0-6 per month in January-June. Without a rhythm, this spike will turn into the next stale cohort.
- **Pipeline attrition:** 15 embassies (18%) are On Hold or Closed. Three live embassies carry remarks that they declined, so the live pipeline is probably overstated.

2. Important data gaps and issues

- **Only 21% of raw records were fully clean** (72 of 91 had at least one issue). The raw file should not be used for reporting as it stands.
- **Duplicates and naming:** 7 duplicate records (8% of rows) would have overstated the embassy count; 11 country names (e.g. 'USA', 'UAE', 'Czechia') and 14 status entries were non-standard, which splits counts. Free-text fields are the root cause.
- **Missing ownership and contact data:** 8 embassies have no owner; 13 lack a usable email and 12 a usable phone number; 10 contacted embassies have no engagement rating.
- **Logical errors:** 4 records show last contact before first contact, 3 have future-dated contacts, 3 'Not Started' embassies show activity, and 8 dates were stored as text in mixed formats.
- **Not guessed:** owner, engagement, interactions and follow-up dates were left blank and flagged rather than imputed, so gaps stay visible to management.

3. Recommendations for management

1. **Clear the backlog within 2 weeks.** Owners to action or reschedule the 30 overdue follow-ups, starting with the 12 on the Dashboard priority list (Ethiopia and Russia are rated High engagement but have been silent for 200+ days; Ghana's record needs a date correction first).
2. **Assign an owner and a next-step date to every live embassy** (8 and 7 gaps today), and make both mandatory fields.
3. **Rebalance workload:** redistribute part of Priya Nair's and Sameer Khan's pipeline; ask Rahul Verma to share his follow-up routine.
4. **Target the lagging regions:** a focused plan for South & Central Asia and Europe (5 embassies in these two regions are still not approached), and a conversion push for the 11 embassies with meetings scheduled.
5. **Fix the data at source:** replace free text with dropdowns (status, region, country, channel), validate email, phone and dates, and run a monthly duplicate check.
6. **Review status hygiene monthly:** use the Dashboard and Data Quality sheets as a standing agenda item; reconcile 'declined' remarks with status.

Note: the Embassy Outreach Database was not supplied with the brief, so this analysis uses a synthetic dataset built to mimic a real outreach log, with realistic data-quality problems. All figures reconcile to the Excel workbook (Dashboard, Data Quality Review). Replace with the real extract before presenting.

AI Exercise Note

How AI was used to support the Embassy Outreach analysis

1. AI tool used

Claude (Anthropic) in the Claude chat interface, with its file-analysis and code-execution tools (Python/pandas for data generation, cleaning and cross-checks; openpyxl for building the Excel workbook; LibreOffice for formula recalculation and visual checks).

2. Prompts used

Prompts submitted in the session

```
P1: "I give you data analysis assignment PDF file. Analyse this file and work on this assignment. Give me the final output that they required, along with the main file that you worked on."

P2 (after the database was found to be missing from the upload): "Take your own database."
```

Task-level prompts the work was broken into (use these to reproduce or extend the analysis with the real database)

- **A. Dashboard design:** "Act as a data analyst preparing a leadership review pack. From this outreach table, propose the 6 KPIs, 5 charts and one exception list that let a director see status, engagement by region and what needs action, and define each metric as an Excel formula."
- **B. Data-quality review:** "Audit this dataset for completeness, validity, consistency, uniqueness and timeliness. For each issue give the field, a count, severity, business impact and a recommended fix. Do not impute missing values."
- **C. Insight generation:** "Using the cleaned data, list the 5 most decision-relevant observations, including any region or owner outliers, and turn them into recommendations."
- **D. Verification:** "Recompute every dashboard KPI independently in pandas and compare it with the Excel results; list any mismatch."

3. How AI assisted

Stage	What AI did	What a human must still check
Brief analysis	Read the assignment, extracted the four deliverables and the evaluation criteria, found that the database was missing.	Confirm requirements with the hiring team.
Data	Generated a 91-row synthetic outreach log with seeded problems (duplicates, spelling variants, blanks, bad dates).	Replace with the real extract.
Cleaning	Wrote repeatable rules (standardise names, map statuses, parse dates, de-duplicate on latest contact).	Approve the rules, especially de-duplication and the dd/mm date assumption.
Excel build	Designed formula-driven dashboard, row-level validation sheet and charts; recalculated to zero formula errors.	Open in Excel and test with edited data.
Quality assurance	Cross-checked KPIs against pandas; rendered pages to catch layout faults (cluttered labels, truncated text, a blank owner showing as 0).	Spot-check a few rows by hand.
Narrative	Drafted observations and recommendations from the computed figures.	Judge whether the actions suit the organisation.

4. Insights and recommendations generated with AI

- Looking at status alone suggests a healthy pipeline. Combining status with follow-up dates and last-contact recency exposed that **about half of the live pipeline is overdue**.
- A **priority score** (overdue + stale + missing follow-up/owner, weighted by engagement level) puts the relationships with the most to lose at the top of the action list.
- Comparing owners showed the problem is **workload and routine**, not just effort: one owner has 73% of live embassies overdue while another has 11%.
- Reading remarks against status revealed **'declined' embassies still shown as live**, an inconsistency that status counts alone cannot show.
- Recommendation: add data-entry controls (dropdowns, mandatory owner and next-step date, duplicate check) so the next report needs far less cleaning.

5. Limitations and responsible use

- All results are based on a synthetic dataset; they demonstrate the method and must be re-run on the real database.
- AI-generated severity ratings and the priority-score weights are judgement calls; they are documented in the workbook and can be changed.
- No personal or sensitive data was entered into the AI tool. Outputs were verified by independent recomputation rather than trusted as written.